

Persist Week of April 20, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at <https://functional-bodybuilding.com> if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x

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Pump Lift 5x

Monday, April 20, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Pump Lift 5x - April

A) Daily Focus Note:

Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day.

If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes)

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Sumo DB RDL

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Low Handle Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Landmine Hack Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Star Plank; 20-30 sec/side

rest 30 sec

Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 10-12 reps

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Pump Lift 5x - April

A) Daily Focus Note:

Max Unbroken Reps

Each week on the barbell Z Press, your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus – not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

:

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side

PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Alternating DB Bench Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 9 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Strict Bar Dip; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Barbell Skullcrushers; 6 @ 31X1 Tempo

directly into

Close Grip Bench Press; 6-12 @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2 sets

Cuban Press; 10-12 reps @ 2020 Tempo

rest 15 sec

Poliquin Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 15 sec

Inchworm Pushup; 7 reps

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Keep the weight and form on the Cuban press high-quality. Perform the raise and pushup with quality, but aim to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 22, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Pump Lift 5x - April

A) Daily Focus Note:

Double Drop Set

In Strength Intensity 1 today, you'll finish with a double drop set to failure after your last working set. Complete your final prescribed set, then immediately reduce the weight by about 30% and perform reps until form failure. Drop the weight by another 30% and go to form failure again. That sequence completes one double drop set. If you're doing pull ups instead of pulldowns, add additional band assistance for each "drop" rather than changing weight.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

Dual DB Rack Carry; 30m

DB Meadow Row; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min):

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the first drop set, don't worry about percentages and instead add back two levels of assistance (or less weight) similar to your first and second working sets. Then, for your second drop set, drop more weight and go to failure. The double drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight from your set of 4. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

DB Bent Shrug; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Cable Forearm Curls or DB Wrist Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Hammer Curl; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec

Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 23, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Pump Lift 5x - April

A) Active Recovery (40 min)

40mins Total Work - Easy Effort

20mins Timer

Bike Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform

20sec Single Leg Wall Sit R

20sec Single Leg Wall Sit L

20sec Star Plank R

20sec Star Plank L

20mins Timer

Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20, stop and perform

20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric L

20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric R

20sec Single Arm Passive Hang L

20sec Single Arm Passive Hang R

*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Pikes and Pancakes

Bodyweight RDL x 10

Elephant Walk Step x 10/side

Pike Stretch x 2 min

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center

Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Friday, April 24, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Pump Lift 5x - April

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl

Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice – they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Hand Support DB Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Back Rack Reverse Lunge

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0

rest 60 sec

Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

DB Suitcase Standing Calf Raise; 10-12 reps @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

3 Way Seated Hip Abduction; 5-8 reps in each position.

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 25, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Pump Lift 5x - April

A) Daily Focus Note:

Heavy Bench Press

The bench press drops to sets of three reps this week. If you're not fully confident in your bench technique, keep your working sets around an RPE 7. That level of intensity is still effective for building strength and muscle while allowing you to maintain control and solid positioning.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position

Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Low Incline Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Single Arm Arnold Z Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warm-up set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 Min):

2-3 sets

Cross Body KB Carry; 20m/side

rest 15 sec

Quadruped Crawl; 10m Forward, 10m Backward

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec

PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

Reach out to us if you need some help adjusting to something that doesn't feel right.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day.

If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Sumo DB RDL

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Low Handle Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Landmine Hack Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Star Plank; 20-30 sec/side

rest 30 sec

Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 10-12 reps

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Max Unbroken Reps

Each week on the barbell Z Press, your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus – not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Strict Bar Dip; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Barbell Skullcrushers; 6 @ 31X1 Tempo

Close Grip Bench Press; 6-12 @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Cable Forearm Curls or DB Wrist Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Hammer Curl; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec

Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Pikes and Pancakes

Bodyweight RDL x 10

Elephant Walk Step x 10/side

Pike Stretch x 2 min

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center

Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Thursday April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl

Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice – they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Hand Support DB Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Back Rack Reverse Lunge

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):

3 sets

Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0

rest 60 sec

Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

DB Suitcase Standing Calf Raise; 10-12 reps @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

3 Way Seated Hip Abduction; 5-8 reps in each position.

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Friday April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Heavy Bench Press

The bench press drops to sets of three reps this week. If you're not fully confident in your bench technique, keep your working sets around an RPE 7. That level of intensity is still effective for building strength and muscle while allowing you to maintain control and solid positioning.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position

Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure

Loading Note:

If using Pull Ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription.

Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the first drop set, don't worry about percentages and instead add back two levels of assistance (or less weight) similar to your first and second working sets. Then, for your second drop set, drop more weight and go to

failure. The double drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight from your set of 4. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):

Low Incline Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

DB Bent Shrug; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2 sets

Cuban Press; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 15 sec

Poliquin Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 15 sec

Inchworm Pushup; 7 reps

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Keep the weight and form on the Cuban press high-quality. Perform the raise and pushup with quality, but aim to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec

PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

Dual KB Gunslinger x 8

Dual KB Clean x 8

Alternating KB Press x 4/arm

*Keep the KB Loads Very Light

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

10 KB Horn Bicep Curls

10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press

10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

Reach out to us if you need some help adjusting to something that doesn't feel right.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Volume and Intensity Progression

Over this six-week progression, reps gradually decrease while weights increase. Some athletes feel more fatigued by higher reps, while others feel it more from heavier loading, so pay attention to how the later weeks affect your body. You might feel energized by fewer reps and heavier weights, or you may notice more fatigue. Neither is right nor wrong – the goal is simply to build awareness of how you respond to different training stress. When the next training block begins, and you return to Week 1, the relationship flips again, bringing you back to higher reps and lighter loads to restart the progression.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1(15 minutes):

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1

weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 RPE =

Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2(12 min):

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription.

Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the first drop set, don't worry about percentages and instead add back two levels of assistance (or less weight) similar to your first and second working sets. Then, for your second drop set, drop more weight and go to failure. The double drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight from your set of 4. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Strict Bar Dip; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Barbell Skullcrushers; 6 @ 31X1 Tempo

directly into

Close Grip Bench Press; 6-12 @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Star Plank; 20-30 sec/side

rest 30 sec

Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 10-12 reps

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying Thoracic Sweep; 5 reps/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):

Shoulder Mobility

Shoulder Circles x5/side

Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min

Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps

Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Prayer Stretch x 2 min

Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side

Passive Hang x 1 min

Wednesday, April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Max Unbroken Reps

Each week on the barbell Z Press, your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus – not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side

PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1(15 min):

Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):

3 sets

Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0

rest 60 sec

Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Cable Forearm Curls or DB Wrist Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Hammer Curl; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec

Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (12-15 min):

Squat Mobility

1. Shinbox Switch x 10/side

2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side

3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch

4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg

5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side

6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min

7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold

8. Russian Babymaker x 10

9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side

10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Friday, April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day. If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Hand Support DB Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1(15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2(15 min):

Low Incline Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Low Handle Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Landmine Hack Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Cross Body KB Carry; 20m/side

rest 15 sec

Quadruped Crawl; 10m Forward, 10m Backward

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.

Cooldown (5 min)

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

Dual KB Gunslinger x 8

Dual KB Clean x 8

Alternating KB Press x 4/arm

*Keep the KB Loads Very Light

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

10 KB Horn Bicep Curls

10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press

10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

Reach out to us if you need some help adjusting to something that doesn't feel right.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Daily Focus Note

Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day. If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2) Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

3) Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Low Handle Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Landmine Hack Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

4-5 Sets @ High Effort

Bike 8/6 Calories (Male/Female)

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

10 Deadstop Hike KBS 70/53#

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

Bike 8/6 Calories

rest 60 sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim to increase the pace for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note: -

Max Unbroken Reps

Each week on the Barbell Z Press, your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus — not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side

PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Strict Bar Dip; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Barbell Skullcrushers; 6 @ 31X1 Tempo

directly into

Close Grip Bench Press; 6-12 @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):

6min As Many Reps As Possible

1000/800m Bike Buy In (Male/Female)

-then in the time remaining-

3-6-9-12-15....

DB Floor Press 50/35#

*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round

rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP (As Many Reps As Possible)

Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Double Drop Set

In Strength Intensity today, you'll finish with a double drop set to failure after your last working set. Complete your final prescribed set, then immediately reduce the weight by about 30% and perform reps until form failure. Drop the weight by another 30% and go to form failure again. That sequence completes one double drop set. If you're doing pullups instead of pulldowns, add additional band assistance for each "drop" rather than changing weight.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

Dual DB Rack Carry; 30m

DB Meadow Row; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure

Loading Note:

If using pullups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the first drop set, don't worry about percentages and instead add back two levels of assistance (or less weight) similar to your first and second working sets. Then, for your second drop set, drop more weight and go to failure. The double drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight from your set of 4. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 Min):

3 sets

DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) High Turnover Cardio:

:

Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets

12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)

20 Kettlebell Ballistic Row (10/arm) 53/35#

Rest 2 minutes

Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets

12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort

KB Goblet Carry 40m 53/35#

Effort Note:

Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set. Take 2 minutes' rest after the first 3 sets. Push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec

Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work :

A) Active Recovery (40 min)

40mins Total Work - Easy Effort

20mins Timer

Bike Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform

20sec Single Leg Wall Sit R

20sec Single Leg Wall Sit L

20sec Star Plank R

20sec Star Plank L

20mins Timer

Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20, stop and perform

20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric L

20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric R

20sec Single Arm Passive Hang L

20sec Single Arm Passive Hang R

*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Pikes and Pancakes

Bodyweight RDL x 10

Elephant Walk Step x 10/side

Pike Stretch x 2 min

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center

Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Friday, April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl

Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice – they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

:

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Hand Support Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible

250m/200m Row (Male/Female)

12 Dual KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#

12 Dual KB Rack Walking Lunge 53/35# or 35/26#

in remaining time:

KB Plank Knee to Elbows

rest 2 mins between sets

Effort Note:

For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform the row, squat, and lunge, then, in the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of the KB Plank Knee to Elbows.

When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Heavy Bench Press

The bench press drops to sets of three reps this week. If you're not fully confident in your bench technique, keep your working sets around an RPE 7. That level of intensity is still effective for building strength and muscle while allowing you to maintain control and solid positioning.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position

Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Low Incline Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 60sec x 12 Sets

1st - 100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs

2nd - 4-8 Pronated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo

3rd - 10-12 DB Push Press 50/35# or 35/20# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 60 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd, and then to the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to set 1 and perform the run or shuttle runs.

*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec

PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

Reach out to us if you need some help adjusting to something that doesn't feel right.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day. If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

Low Handle Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Landmine Hack Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

4-5 Sets @ High Effort

Bike 8/6 Calories (Male/Female)

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

10 Deadstop Hike KBS 70/53#

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

Bike 8/6 Calories

rest 60 sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim to increase the pace for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Double Drop Set

In Strength Intensity today, you'll finish with a double drop set to failure after your last working set. Complete your final prescribed set, then immediately reduce the weight by about 30% and perform reps until form failure. Drop the weight by another 30% and go to form failure again. That sequence completes one double drop set. If you're doing pullups instead of pulldowns, add additional band assistance for each "drop" rather than changing weight.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side

PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the first drop set, don't worry about percentages and instead add back two levels of assistance (or less weight) similar to your first and second working sets. Then, for your second drop set, drop more weight and go to failure. The double drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight from your set of 4.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):

6min As Many Reps As Possible

1000/800m Bike Buy In (Male/Female)

-then in the time remaining-

3-6-9-12-15....

DB Floor Press 50/35#

*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round

rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP (As Many Reps As Possible)

Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Pikes and Pancakes

Bodyweight RDL x 10

Elephant Walk Step x 10/side

Pike Stretch x 2 min

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center

Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Thursday, April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl

Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice – they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Hand Support Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible

250m/200m Row (Male/Female)

12 Dual KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#

12 Dual KB Rack Walking Lunge 53/35# or 35/26#

in remaining time:

KB Plank Knee to Elbows

rest 2 mins between sets

Effort Note:

For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform the row, squat, and lunge, then, in the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of the KB Plank Knee to Elbows. When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Heavy Bench Press

The bench press drops to sets of three reps this week. If you're not fully confident in your bench technique, keep your working sets around an RPE 7. That level of intensity is still effective for building strength and muscle while allowing you to maintain control and solid positioning.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec cardio of choice

Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position

Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Low Incline Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 60sec x 12 Sets

1st - 100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs

2nd - 4-8 Pronated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo

3rd - 10-12 DB Push Press 50/35# or 35/20# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 60 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd, and then to the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to set 1 and perform the run or shuttle runs.

*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec

PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

Dual KB Gunslinger x 8

Dual KB Clean x 8

Alternating KB Press x 4/arm

**Keep the KB Loads Very Light*

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

10 KB Horn Bicep Curls

10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press

10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

Reach out to us if you need some help adjusting to something that doesn't feel right.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Max Unbroken Reps

On this week of the front squat your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus – not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Strict Bar Dip; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Barbell Skullcrushers; 6 reps @ 31X1 Tempo

directly into

Close Grip Bench Press; 6-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

4-5 Sets @ High Effort

Bike 8/6 Calories (Male/Female)

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

10 Deadstop Hike KBS 70/53#

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

Bike 8/6 Calories

rest 60 sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim to increase the pace for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Sidelying Thoracic Sweep; 5 reps/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):

Shoulder Mobility

Shoulder Circles x5/side

Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min

Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps

Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Prayer Stretch x 2 min

Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side

Passive Hang x 1 min

Wednesday, April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

KB Rack Lunge

Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. For weighted lunges, avoid loading it with too much weight. A moderate weight will create plenty of stimulus for the legs. When the load gets too high, the body often shifts tension into the low back, adductors, or hamstrings instead of the target muscles. Stay controlled and own each rep.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice
Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible

250m/200m Row (Male/Female)

12 Dual KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#

12 Dual KB Rack Walking Lunge 53/35# or 35/26#

in remaining time:

KB Plank Knee to Elbows

rest 2 mins between sets

Effort Note:

For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform the row, squat, and lunge, then, in the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of the KB Plank Knee to Elbows.

When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec

Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (12-15min):

Squat Mobility

Shinbox Switch x 10/side

Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side

Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch

Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg

Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Frog Stretch x 1-2 min

Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold

Russian Babymaker x 10

Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side

Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Friday, April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

DB Press in Conditioning

This training block uses three different dumbbell press variations in the conditioning section, each providing a slightly different stimulus. The traditional DB bench press serves as the baseline. The low incline DB bench press adds a longer range of motion and challenges the pecs from a slightly different angle. The floor press challenges the triceps a bit more, but still has a strong emphasis on the pecs. Each variation brings its own benefit, and rotating through all three helps develop a more balanced and resilient shoulder complex for horizontal pressing.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Hand Support Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):

6min As Many Reps As Possible

1000/800m Bike Buy In (Male/Female)

-then in the time remaining-

3-6-9-12-15....

DB Floor Press 50/35#

*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round

rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP (As Many Reps As Possible)

Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min) :

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

Dual KB Gunslinger x 8

Dual KB Clean x 8

Alternating KB Press x 4/arm

**Keep the KB Loads Very Light*

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

10 KB Horn Bicep Curls

10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press

10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Work in Lesson - Week 5

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With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day. If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min): 3 Rounds

1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2) Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

3) Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):

1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Romanian Deadlift

10 Strict Press

10 Front Squat

10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold

10 sec Front Rack Hold

10 sec Front Squat Hold

+

4-5 sets; rest 90-120sec between sets

2 Power Clean + 6 Jump Lunge (3/side)

Sets 1-2: Easy

Set 3-4: Moderate

Set 5: Challenging

*Aim for max power/height on every jump.

D) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

1. Low Handle Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

- rest 60 sec

2. Landmine Hack Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Interval Weight Training: Week 5

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

300/240m Row (Male/Female)

18 Wall Balls 20/14# to 10/9' Target

12 DB Suitcase Low Box Step Up 50/35# or 35/20# to 20/16" (6/leg)

- in remaining time:

Lateral Arc Med Ball Slam 20/14#

- rest 2mins between sets

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

2) Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Max Unbroken Reps

Each week on the Barbell Z Press, your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus – not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
- 2) Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
- 3) PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles 5-7 reps/side

C) Engine Hot Start (10-12 min):

Every 3:30 x 2-3 sets at Increasing Pace

Row 250m/200m (Male/Female)

40sec L-Sit Flutter or Tuck L-Sit Flutter

Row 250m/200m

rest remaining time

Effort Note

Set 1 - Moderate

Set 2 - Moderate to Hard

Set 3 - Hard

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

1. Strict Bar Dip; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 60 sec

2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 6 @ 31X1 Tempo

- directly into

3. Close Grip Bench Press; 6-12 @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Upper Couplets (14 min):

6min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

1000/800m Bike Buy In (Male/Female)

-then in the time remaining-

3-6-9-12-15....

DB Floor Press 50/35#

*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round

rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP

Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

2) Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Double Drop Set

In Strength Intensity 1 today, you'll finish with a double drop set to failure after your last working set. Complete your final prescribed set, then immediately reduce the weight by about 30% and perform reps until form failure. Drop the weight by another 30% and go to form failure again. That sequence completes one double drop set. If you're doing pull ups instead of pulldowns, add additional band assistance for each "drop" rather than changing weight.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

1) Dual DB Rack Carry; 30m

2) DB Meadow Row; 10-12 reps/side

C) Kettlebell Hot Start (10 min):

4 Rounds Increasing Effort:

18/15 Calorie Row (Male/Female)

7 KB Split Snatch Right 53/35#

7 KB Split Snatch Left 53/35#

rest 45 sec between rounds

Round 1 - Moderate

Round 2 - Hard

Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Double Drop Set to Failure

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the first drop set, don't worry about percentages and instead add back two levels of assistance (or less weight) similar to your first and second working sets. Then, for your second drop set, drop more weight and go to failure. The double drop sets are performed right after you have adjusted the weight from your set of 4.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

1. DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Aerobic Carry (18 min):

For Time

40-30-20-10 (40-32-24-16-8)

Bike Cals (Male/Female)

14-14-14-14

Cross Body Toe Touch (7/side)

10-10-10-10

DB Goblet Box Step Overs 50/35# or 35/20#

*100ft Farmers Walk after each round.

*18min Time Cap.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

Week 5

1-2 sets

1) Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

2) Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec

3) Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):

40mins Total Work - Easy Effort

20mins Timer

Bike Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform

- 20sec Single Leg Wall Sit R

- 20sec Single Leg Wall Sit L

- 20sec Star Plank R

- 20sec Star Plank L

20mins Timer

Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform

- 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric L

- 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric R

- 20sec Single Arm Passive Hang L

- 20sec Single Arm Passive Hang R

*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Week 5

Pikes and Pancakes

Bodyweight RDL x 10

Elephant Walk Step x 10/side

Pike Stretch x 2 min

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center

Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Friday, April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl

Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice – they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint

2) Hand Support Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side

3) Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):

Barbell Warm-up:

1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift

10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press

10 Overhead Squat

10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold

10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold

10 sec Overhead Squat Hold

+

Every 75-90sec x 8-10 sets

1 Full Snatch @ about 80-85%

- rest until the next :75-:90sec

*Perform a few easy ramp up sets if needed. The goal here is lots of quality reps at submaximal weight.

Sets 1-10: Moderate

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 60 sec

2. Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec

- rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Threshold Lower Body (15-18 min):

2 sets:

Bike 1k/900m (Male/Female)

25 Goblet Squat 53/35#

15 Squat Jumps

15 Toes to Bar

rest 45sec

15 Toes to Bar

15 Squat Jumps

25 Goblet Squat 53/35#

Bike 1k/900m

rest 45sec

G) Cooldown (5 min):

Week 5

1-2 sets

- 1) Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
- 2) Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
- 3) Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:

Heavy Bench Press

The bench press drops to sets of three reps this week. If you're not fully confident in your bench technique, keep your working sets around an RPE 7. That level of intensity is still effective for building strength and muscle while allowing you to maintain control and solid positioning.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec cardio of choice
- 2) Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps
- 3) Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
- 4) Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Gymnastics Skills (12 min):

Every 3:00 x 4 sets

Bike 12/10 Cals (Male/Female)

2 Strict Muscle Up

2 Strict Ring Pull Ups

8 Pike Leg Lift Over

Effort Note:

Any muscle up variation is acceptable in place of the strict ring muscle up. A regression may be the following:

Strict Ring Muscle Up > Muscle Up > Bar Muscle Up > Band Assisted Muscle Up > Muscle Up Ring Row + Ring Dip

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Low Incline Barbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 60sec x 12 Sets

1st - 100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs

2nd - 4-8 Pronated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo

3rd - 10-12 DB Push Press 50/35# or 35/20# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 60 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd, and then to the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to set 1 and perform the run or shuttle runs.

*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec

2) PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

3) Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side

4) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

Reach out to us if you need some help adjusting to something that doesn't feel right.

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, April 20th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Strength Balance Squat Progression

The intensity of the strength balance section is adjustable based on what your body needs that day. If you're feeling good and want to push it, you can take the sets closer to failure. If your goal is more about structural balance and restoring the joints after the main strength work, slow things down and prioritize precision. Move with control, own every position, and focus on quality over fatigue. Choose the intent that supports your long-term progress.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2) Heels Elevated Wall Sit; 30-45 sec

3) Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):

DB Suitcase Split Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets

1. DB Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. Goblet Pulse Squat; 20-30 sec

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):

4-5 Sets @ High Effort

4 Shuttle Run

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

10 DB Sumo RDL @ 20X0 Tempo 50/35# (Male/Female)

5 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks

4 Shuttle Run

rest 60 sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim to increase the pace for each set.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side

2) Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Max Unbroken Reps

Each week on the Z Press, your final set is a max unbroken rep set. This is your chance to increase the intensity and get the most from the movement. Max reps doesn't mean sloppy reps. Maintain solid mechanics and stop when your form breaks down. The goal is a strong, challenging stimulus – not chasing a specific number.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

- 1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
- 2) Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
- 3) PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Alternating Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

1. DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Incline Prone Dumbbell Row; 8-10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):

6min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

400m Run

-then in the time remaining-

3-6-9-12-15....

DB Floor Press 50/35#

*4 Burpees between each round

rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP

Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In Run before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

2) Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 22nd, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist Minimalist

A) Active Recovery Work: Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

Pikes and Pancakes

Bodyweight RDL x 10

Elephant Walk Step x 10/side

Pike Stretch x 2 min

Pancake Stretch x 1 min L, 1 min R, 2 min Center

Air Squat x 3-5 with 10 sec hold in bottom.

Thursday, April 23rd, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl

Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice – they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

2-3 Sets

- 1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
- 2) Hand Support Knee Over Toe Split Squat; 10 reps/side
- 3) Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec
- rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

12 Dual DB Rack Squat 50/35# (Male/Female)

24 DB Suitcase Walking Lunge 53/35# (12/side)

12 Skater Jumps (6/side)

- in remaining time:

DB Plank Knee to Elbows

- rest 2 mins between sets

Effort Note:

For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform the squat, lunge, and jumps then, in the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of the DB Plank Knee to Elbow. When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

2) Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

3) Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, April 24th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:

Heavy Bench Press

The bench press drops to sets of four reps this week. If you're not fully confident in your technique, keep your working sets around an RPE 7. That level of intensity is still effective for building strength and muscle while allowing you to maintain control and solid positioning.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):

2-3 Rounds

1) 90 sec cardio of choice

2) Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

3) Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position

4) Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Incline Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Single Arm Dumbbell Row; 6-8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

- rest 30 sec

2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):

Every 60sec x 12 Sets

1st - 100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs

2nd - 4-8 Pronated Strict Pullup @ 30X0 Tempo

3rd - 10-12 DB Push Press 50/35# or 35/20# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

*Every 60 sec you begin a new set, and it starts with the 1st, then moves to the 2nd, and then to the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to set 1 and perform the run or shuttle runs.

*Pull-Ups - Scale your pull-ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1) Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec

2) PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

3) Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side

4) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 25th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist Minimalist

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

Dual KB Gunslinger x 8

Dual KB Clean x 8

Alternating KB Press x 4/arm

**Keep the KB Loads Very Light*

Run/Bike/Row 90sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x5

2 Sets

10 KB Horn Bicep Curls

10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press

10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

Front Splits

1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, April 26th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist Minimalist

Work in Lesson - Week 5

Pain doesn't mean quitting - it means adjusting.

If your back is irritated, we don't shut down training altogether. We look at what we can train well and double down on that. Maybe that means pulling heavy hinges out for a week, swapping back squats for a safer variation, or leaning into upper body and core work while things calm down. Training doesn't have to be all or nothing.

Injuries are frustrating, no question about it. But they can also be an opportunity to focus on what your body does tolerate well. That might mean improving a lift that's been lagging, building strength in a different pattern, increasing your aerobic work, dialing in your steps, or finally giving consistent attention to the accessory work you've been skipping. Progress doesn't have to stop just because one area needs a little patience - often it just shifts direction for a while.

Remember that longevity isn't about avoiding stress completely. It's about adapting intelligently so you can keep showing up consistently. The athletes who last the longest aren't the ones who never deal with aches or setbacks - they're the ones who learn how to adjust without stepping away from training altogether.

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